Detailed solution overview

Branch Assist is a locally runnable generative conversational solution over eleven operational procedures. It combines structured document processing, hybrid retrieval, evidence-based generation and inspectable output checks. The supporting materials include a six-slide solution presentation, measured evaluation, response traces and a timed demonstration guide.

What was built and why

The system helps employees ask a procedure question, inspect the supporting passages and refine the situation conversationally. Retrieval-augmented generation was chosen to keep the evidence explicit and replaceable. Fine-tuning would not itself provide reliable citations or source version control. A local model removes the API-key dependency and makes the demonstration reproducible on this computer.

The final generator is Qwen/Qwen3-4B-GGUF:Q4_K_M. The Qwen3 model uses four-bit GGUF inference through llama.cpp on CPU. An earlier Qwen2.5 1.5B float32 baseline produced too many distracting details and withheld drafts; its complete results are retained separately. Model choice was evaluated empirically rather than inferred from published benchmarks.

The solution uses structure-aware HTML parsing, a JSONL passage store, BM25 lexical search, 384-dimensional MiniLM embeddings, reciprocal rank fusion, MiniLM cross-encoder reranking, bounded evidence, actual local generation, citation-local numeric checks and a DeBERTa NLI screening signal. The Wells Fargo–inspired version 2 workspace exposes a searchable procedure library and an Evidence desk with Evidence, Checks and Activity views. The workspace uses the supplied Cayman Bank documents as its knowledge collection.

Version 2 checks original sources and cached-index fingerprints on every supported request. It binds explicit citations to individual claims and records the source passage and evidence window behind each support check. A failed draft may receive one correction using the same evidence; the revised draft must pass the same checks or be withheld. Actual stage events and deterministic decision criteria are visible; the interface does not fabricate private model reasoning or a confidence percentage. Details are in the version 2 design.

Solution presentation

The six-slide presentation covers the business objective and solution scope, document engineering, architecture and technology choices, user experience and follow-ups, quality evaluation, and the demonstration. Speaker notes support a 20-minute explanation followed by a 15-minute walkthrough. The presentation package contains solution materials and excludes implementation source.

Input review and content preservation

The supplied corpus contains 79,424 extracted words and 139 HTML tables including nested tables. It is indexed into 1,388 passages. PR1779 is much larger than the other procedures and contains several account-type workflows.

Procedure	Subject	Extracted words	Passages	Publication in supplied source
PR1000	Notary: Services, Supplies and Manager Responsibilities	2,909	53	January 29, 2026
PR1263	Secure Destruction, Store Materials and Records, and Record Holds	4,781	103	October 10, 2025

PR1277	Primary and Secondary Identification Requirements	1,404	25	January 7, 2026
PR1779	Business Deposit Account: Estate, Receivership, Government Entities, Business Trusts, Girl Scouts	38,884	630	December 10, 2025
PR1949	Savings Bonds: Rate and Redeem	4,654	82	December 17, 2025
PR2306	Copy Requests: Statements, Debit or Credit Items, and Account Documentation	7,980	175	January 30, 2026
PR2321	Approvals and Overrides – Teller	3,229	52	January 20, 2026
PR472	Payment Maintenance: Consumer and Small Business Lending	3,962	84	December 4, 2025
PR607	Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN) and Foreign Status Maintenance, Certification, and Backup Withholding	4,483	84	December 29, 2025
PR63	Coin-Counting Machines: Sell Full Coin Bags, Balance, Test	1,116	21	October 9, 2025
PR7554	Incoming Currency and Coin Shipments	6,022	79	January 30, 2026

The original files were preserved. Each passage records its procedure ID, title, publication text, source filename, source SHA256, section hierarchy, anchor, ordinal, text, content type and table/row metadata when applicable. A source revision changes passage identity and requires rebuilding the index.

The parser recognizes the HTML export's policy classes and handles UTF-8 explicitly. It excludes scripts and display-only styling, does not follow links, and retains table column labels, row conditions, rowspans and colspans. Nested table text is included once. Long table rows repeat their leftmost condition in continuation passages.

Narrative grouping targets roughly 110 words within sections, with 20-word overlap when splitting long content. Unsplit table rows can reach 130 words; continuation condition prefixes can make them longer. These are word targets, not exact token counts. All checked source paragraph five-word sequences were found by the extraction audit across the eleven documents; that establishes a limited text-preservation diagnostic, not semantic validation of the table parser.

How a question is answered

- Bound and check the question. Recognize an explicit procedure, a named topic or a contextual follow-up.
- Search BM25 and normalized dense vectors. Combine the rankings with RRF and rerank the candidates jointly with the question.
- Abstain if evidence signals are weak. Otherwise construct a pack of up to three nonduplicate passages, targeting at most 520 words.
- Give the selected evidence and resolved question to the local generative model. The prompt requires a direct, concise answer with conditions, exceptions and source labels.
- Check citation labels, claim-local attribution, numeric values and recognized boundaries against the cited passages; screen claim support with verbatim matching or NLI.
- If a draft fails, allow one bounded correction with the same evidence and deterministic feedback, then apply the same checks. Display a passing answer with evidence; otherwise withhold it and show sources. Unsupported questions receive abstention or clarification. Record the actual stages and decision for inspection.

Source hashes detect changed originals; the embedding manifest binds the exact vector-matrix bytes and the passage-file hash. Startup validates dimensions, finite values and normalization, and requests detect changes to the cached matrix file as well as metadata. Plain JSON and NumPy files avoid loading pickled index objects. Runtime model loading uses local files; external linked documents are not retrieved. Some supplied links are

placeholders and are not treated as evidence.

Follow-ups and user experience

Browser sessions own their question history; cached models/indexes do not own user conversation memory. Prior user questions can resolve an elliptical follow-up. A hypothetical repeating the same topic or procedure ID retains the earlier situation, including conditions such as an emailed document. A follow-up naming a new task in the same procedure retains scope without repeating unrelated prior-task keywords. Named topic changes replace previous scope. Every follow-up performs fresh retrieval; previous generated claims are never authoritative evidence.

The interface provides starter scenarios, a searchable procedure library, optional document-scoped retrieval, citation selection, original-procedure downloads, publication information, reset, opt-in investigation export and feedback. The Evidence desk separates exact passages, claim-support checks and observed activity. Conflicting document scope prompts clarification, and a new unsupported response does not silently show an earlier response's sources. The resolver remains bounded and can misinterpret ambiguous or long conversations.

Measured results

The suite includes 30 ordinary procedure questions, four two-turn conversations and six guardrail questions. Labels are AI-authored and source-checked. The 19/11 development/challenge split is not an independent blind holdout after development inspection.

Retrieval method	Evidence hit@5	MRR@5	Local median retrieval seconds
BM25	90.0%	0.798	0.036
Dense	93.3%	0.818	0.035
Hybrid + reranker	100.0%	0.928	1.484

Retrieval hit@5 measures whether at least one labelled relevant passage was in the first five, not whether all applicable evidence was retrieved or an answer was correct. Repeated equivalent passages are allowed by the label locators.

Answer diagnostic	Observed result
Ordinary questions with all required fact groups, automatic proxy	76.7% of 30
Mean required-fact group coverage, automatic proxy	76.7%
Withheld drafts shown as source excerpts	6 of 35 generated evaluations
Expected guardrail response status	100.0% of 6
Serial local end-to-end p50 / p95, generated evaluations	13.81s / 23.92s
Mean generated-draft word count	28.0
Bounded correction attempts / revised answers released	9 / 2
Ordinary-question response outcome counts	{'answered': 23, 'evidence_only': 5, 'unsupported': 2}
Follow-up final-turn fact proxies	F01.2: miss, F02.2: pass, F03.2: miss, F04.2: pass

The latency measurements exclude initial model loading and are from serial requests on the local CPU; they are not a throughput benchmark. Word count is a conciseness diagnostic, not proof of sufficient context. Term matching can pass wrong statements or miss correct paraphrases. NLI is fallible. These results must not be

described as independently established accuracy.

Version 2 permits one correction after a failed draft, using the same evidence and check feedback. This increases the worst-case generation work. 2 of 9 revised evaluated drafts passed release checks in this run. This is a screened-release count, not independent confirmation of the revisions' correctness.

Regression cases missing at least one required fact group, including source-only outcomes: N03, B01, S03, C01, A03, T01, H02, F01.2, F03.2. Review their raw responses and evidence in artifacts/evaluation/answer_details.json. The report does not hide fallback as generated-answer success.

Testing and observed engineering lessons

Focused automated tests cover table row/column condition preservation, nested table duplication, UTF-8, stable IDs, source revisions, real-corpus facts, follow-up scope, topic changes, session isolation, invalid citations, invented amounts, equivalent currency formatting, missing paragraph citations, stale sources, direct instruction attacks and obvious identifiers. Separate browser checks exercise the actual local app and save screenshots.

The recorded automated test run contains 49 tests with 0 failures/errors. The live browser integration check passed actual generation, an explicit single-versus-dual-control follow-up, source inspection, complete transcript export, independent browser sessions and reset. The browser reported no client errors. Results and screenshots are retained under artifacts/.

Initial failures combined rules from different situations and invented an exception rationale despite valid citations. Shorter passages, stronger reranking and a larger quantized generator reduced some weaknesses. Claim screening adds a conservative boundary but can withhold valid answers. A narrow evidence pack also trades lower distraction against missing exceptions elsewhere. These are documented tradeoffs, not solved problems.

What a production version still needs

Independent SME-authored and adjudicated cases are the first priority. Evaluate accuracy, relevance, completeness and conciseness separately, and treat critical errors independently of averages. Include unseen scenarios, long conversations, cross-references, conditional tables, outdated/conflicting sources, malicious retrieved content and realistic employee tasks.

Production also needs authoritative effective policy versions, approved ingestion and rollback, employee SSO, document-level entitlements, approved model selection, redacted audit/retention, monitoring, rate limits, concurrency, timeouts, escalation and required enterprise review. Local processing and simple identifier patterns do not replace these controls.

The recommended next step is a scoped validation phase with procedure owners and model/platform teams. A pilot should depend on agreed critical-error, coverage, correctness, completeness and latency gates and measured employee benefit over existing search. No productivity, cost saving or enterprise-compliance achievement is claimed here.

Where to find the deliverables

- submission/Branch_Assist_Solution_Presentation_Final.pptx: six editable slides and presenter notes.
- submission/Branch_Assist_Solution_Presentation_Final.pdf: matching slide PDF.
- submission/Demo_Runbook.pdf: timed presentation and demonstration guide.
- submission/Recorded_Demo.pdf: clearly labelled saved responses for rehearsal and backup.
- submission/Presentation_Materials.zip: allowlisted source-free presentation package.

- docs/ARCHITECTURE.md: component design, decisions, parameters and production path.
- docs/ASSIGNMENT_REVIEW.md: every requirement, acceptance evidence and three-day plan.
- docs/AI_USE_AND_VALIDATION.md: development/runtime AI use and validation boundaries.
- docs/TECHNICAL_WALKTHROUGH.md: technical design decisions and review questions.
- evaluation/REVIEW_RUBRIC.md: independent-review scoring and proposed release gates.
- artifacts/index/, artifacts/evaluation/ and artifacts/runtime_manifest.json: reproducible source, measurement and model provenance.

Run the application using README.md. Inspect the recorded evidence, measured results and documented limitations when reviewing the solution.